

UNIT 3

INTERNET SAFETY AND ETHICS



Learning Objectives

- Protect personal information and create strong passwords.
- Recognize and avoid suspicious links and websites.
- Adjust privacy settings and share information responsibly.
- Practise respectful and kind behaviour online.
- Identify and respond to cyberbullying effectively.
- Respect copyright laws and avoid unethical online practices.

The internet has become a central part of our lives. We use it for schoolwork, entertainment, connecting with friends, and even shopping. However, while the internet offers many opportunities, it also comes with risks. It is important for everyone, especially students, to understand how to stay safe online and use the internet responsibly. This chapter will guide you through online safety, protecting your privacy, and behaving responsibly in the digital world.

Online Safety

Online safety means protecting yourself from harm while using the internet. There are many ways you can stay safe while browsing, socializing, and learning online. Here are a few important tips:

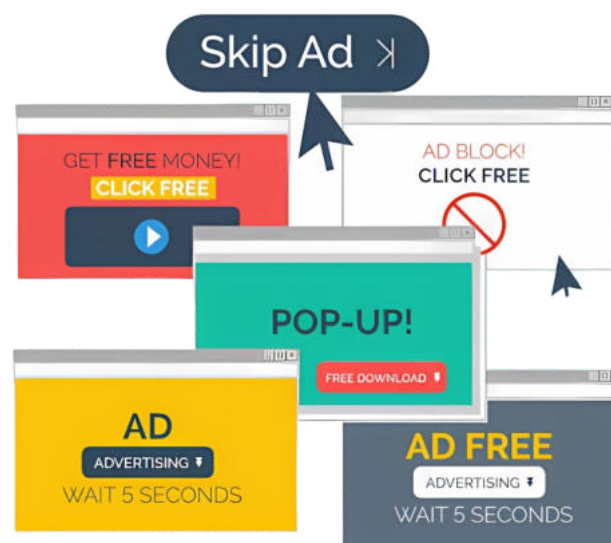
1. Keep Personal Information Private: Never share your full name, address, phone number, school name, or any other private details online unless you're sure it's safe. Avoid posting personal pictures or videos that could reveal your location or identity.



2. Create Strong Passwords: Always use strong, unique passwords for your accounts. A strong password includes a mix of uppercase letters, lowercase letters, numbers, and symbols. Avoid using easily guessable passwords like "12345" or "password."



3. Avoid Clicking Suspicious Links: Be careful about clicking on links or downloading files from unknown sources. These could be harmful and lead to viruses or scams.



4. Report Suspicious Behavior: If you see something suspicious online, such as an unfamiliar website or a message from someone you don't know, always report it to a trusted adult. Never engage in conversations with strangers.



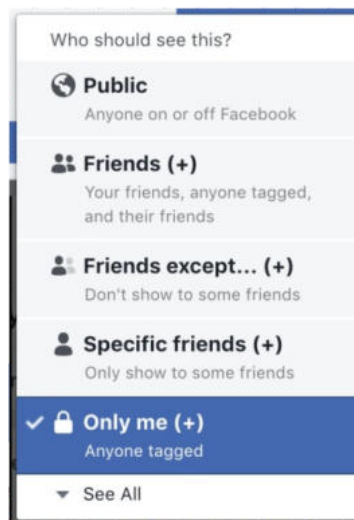
5. Use Secure Websites: Always make sure the websites you visit are secure, especially when entering personal information like credit card numbers. Look for a small lock icon next to the website's URL in the address bar.



Protecting Your Privacy

Your privacy is important, and you have the right to control what information is shared about you online. Here's how to protect your privacy:

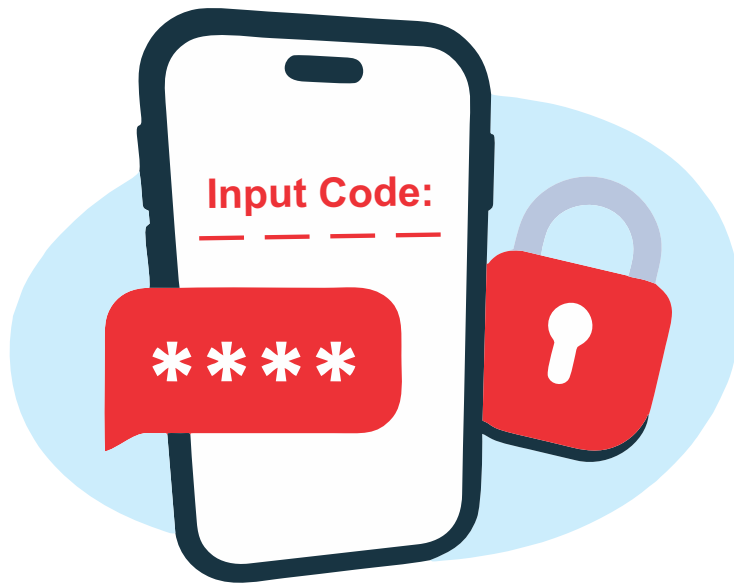
1. Review Privacy Settings: Social media platforms, websites, and apps allow you to control who can see your information. Always check and adjust privacy settings to ensure that only people you trust can see your posts, pictures, and personal information.



2. Be Careful with Social Media: Before posting anything online, ask yourself if it's something you want to be shared with everyone forever. Even if you delete a post, it could still be shared or saved by others.



3. Don't Share Passwords: Never share your passwords with anyone, not even your closest friends. If someone knows your password, they can access your accounts and personal information.



4. Use Trusted Websites: Stick to well-known websites and services when sharing personal information. Avoid entering sensitive information on websites that seem unfamiliar or untrustworthy.



https://

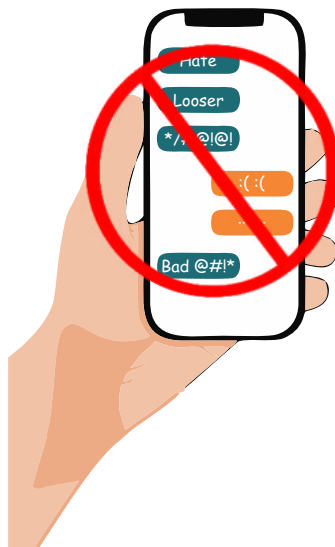
Cyberbullying and How to Deal With It

Cyberbullying is when someone uses the internet to harass, intimidate, or hurt others. It can happen through social media, online games, or even text messages. Cyberbullying can be very harmful, so it's important to know how to deal with it.

1. Don't Respond to Bullies: If someone is bullying you online, don't respond to their messages or posts. Engaging with the bully can make things worse.



2. Block the Bully: Most social media platforms and online services allow you to block someone who is bothering you. This stops them from contacting you or seeing your posts.



3. Talk to an Adult: If you're being bullied online, it's important to talk to a parent, teacher, or another trusted adult. They can help you handle the situation and provide support.



4. Report the Bullying: Social media platforms and websites have reporting tools for cyberbullying. If someone is bullying you or others, report their behaviour to the platform administrators.



Ethical Use of Technology

Ethical use of technology means using devices, the internet, and digital tools in a way that is fair, responsible, and respectful to others. Here are some guidelines for ethical technology use:

1. Respect Copyright Laws: Don't download or share copyrighted material (such as music, movies, or software) without permission from the owner. Always make sure you are legally allowed to use content.



2. Don't Hack or Cheat: Never attempt to hack into systems, cheat in games, or steal digital information. Hacking is illegal and unethical, and it can lead to serious consequences.



**NO
HACKING**

3. Be Honest Online: Always tell the truth when interacting online. Lying or misrepresenting yourself online can harm your reputation and confuse others.



As we continue to spend more time online, it's important to follow these safety and ethical guidelines to protect yourself and others. The internet is a powerful tool, but it comes with responsibility. By practising online safety, protecting your privacy, and behaving responsibly, you can enjoy all the positive aspects of the digital world while avoiding its risks. Always remember that the internet is a place where respect, kindness, and caution are key to having a safe and enjoyable experience.

EXERCISES

01: Choose the correct answer.

1. What is the best way to create a strong password?

- a) Use only numbers
- b) Use a mix of letters, numbers, and symbols
- c) Use your name and date of birth
- d) Use simple words

2. What should you do if you encounter a suspicious link online?

- a) Click it to see where it leads
- b) Ignore it and continue browsing
- c) Report it to a trusted adult
- d) Share it with friends

3. What is the best way to handle cyberbullying?

- a) Respond to the bully with hurtful messages
- b) Block the bully and report their behaviour
- c) Ignore the bully
- d) Tell the bully you're going to report them

4. Which of the following is a responsible digital behaviour?

- a) Sharing personal information with strangers
- b) Copying someone's work without credit
- c) Posting mean comments about others
- d) Being respectful and kind to others online

5. How can you protect your privacy online?

- a) Share personal details freely with friends
- b) Use strong and unique passwords
- c) Leave your social media account open to everyone
- d) Never review your privacy settings

6. What does the lock icon in the URL bar of a website signify?

- a) The website is unsafe
- b) The website is secure
- c) The website is slow
- d) The website is blocked

7. Which of the following is an example of ethical online behaviour?

- a) Downloading movies without permission
- b) Citing sources when using someone else's work
- c) Sharing someone's personal information without consent
- d) Hacking into a friend's account

8. What should you do before posting online?

- a) Post immediately without thinking
- b) Ensure your post is private
- c) Think about how it may affect others and your reputation
- d) Ask others for approval

9. What should you do if a stranger sends you a message online?

- a) Reply politely to get to know them
- b) Share your contact details for further communication
- c) Ignore the message and report it if necessary
- d) Invite them to your social media profiles

10. Why is it important to review privacy settings regularly?

- a) To allow everyone to see your posts
- b) To ensure your profile looks good
- c) To control who can view your information and keep it secure
- d) To share more information publicly

02: Fill in the blanks.

1. A _____ means protecting yourself from harm while using the internet.
2. Personal information like your _____ should never be shared with strangers online.
3. Always use a _____ to protect your online accounts.
4. A _____ is a sign that the website you're visiting is secure.
5. Never share your _____ with anyone, even your best friend.
6. Cyberbullying is when someone uses the internet to _____ others.

03: Tick True or False for each statement.

	TRUE	FALSE
You should always share your passwords with your best friend.	☐	☐
Personal information should be shared only with trusted websites and people.	☐	☐
It is safe to click on any link in an email if it looks interesting.	☐	☐
Cyberbullying is only harmful to the victim and not to the person who is doing it.	☐	☐
Being respectful and kind online is important to maintain good relationships	☐	☐
You should always check privacy settings on social media platforms.	☐	☐

04: Match the columns.

Column A	Column B
Cyberbullying	Should be kept private to maintain online security
Personal Information	Negative behaviour online meant to harm others
Secure Website	Indicates data is encrypted and safe to enter details
Strong Password	Protecting yourself from risks and dangers online

05: Answer the following questions briefly.

1. What is online safety, and why is it important?
2. How can you protect your privacy while using the internet?
3. What should you do if you experience cyberbullying?
4. What is the role of a strong password in protecting your online accounts?
5. Why is it important to respect others' privacy online?

06: Provide detailed answers for the following questions.

- 1.** Explain the importance of online safety and the steps you can take to protect yourself while using the internet.
- 2.** Describe the concept of cyberbullying and how it can affect both the victim and the person who engages in it. What are some ways to deal with it?
- 3.** What are some best practices for responsible digital behaviour when using social media platforms and online spaces?
- 4.** How can you promote a positive online environment?



Lab Activity 1: Create a Strong Password:



Learn the importance of strong passwords and how they protect online accounts.

Create a strong password for a fictional online account using a mix of uppercase letters, lowercase letters, numbers, and symbols. Write it down and then analyze why your password is strong or weak based on these criteria.

Lab Activity 2: Privacy Settings Review:



Understand the importance of controlling who can see your information online.

Review the privacy settings of your social media accounts (e.g., Facebook, Instagram, or any other platform). Adjust them so only your friends can see your posts. Take a screenshot of your settings and explain the changes you made.